

Assignment 1c

Reflection

Reflection on Value Based Leadership and business innovation

I have learned that values determine our behaviour [1], and that leadership involves behaviours that help people align their collective direction to execute strategic plans and continually renew an organization [2]. Consequently, I would define value-based leadership as leadership that creates a positive and meaningful impact by living your values and leading with purpose. This inspires others and fosters a culture of trust, respect, and authenticity within a team.

I see Gandhi as an inspiration; he stood for peace and independence and led by example through peaceful acts of rebellion. Although under British suppression, he showed remarkable resilience and his actions and protests resonated with the masses which led India to independence. Gandhi's empathetic nature for the people of India helped him during these times and made him a notable leader of the movement. He shows how you can lead through your values, which can provide a direction that more people can align to. Through value-based leadership, a leader can align a collective direction to execute a common goal that the whole collective can adhere to.

Following this example, I therefore see a good leader having three main qualities: communication, empathy, and resilience. Additionally, a leader should be adaptable and make decisions based on the situation. Context is crucial in leadership, ensuring leaders effectively respond to the complexities and nuances of different situations, thus developing a more dynamic, resilient, and high-performing team. The Situational Leadership framework (Figure 1) is flexible and enables leaders to tailor their approach to their team's needs and individual members [3].

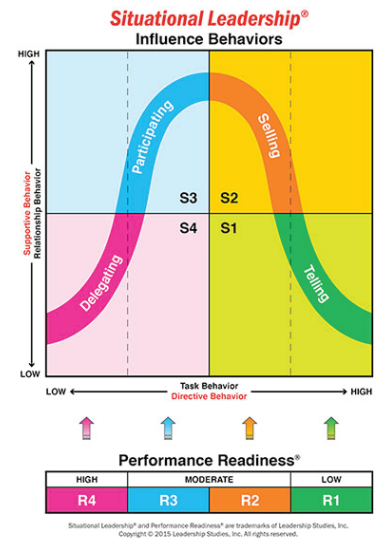


Figure 1: Situational Leadership Framework [3]

I find this framework to be the most effective. From my experience with my team and my M1.1 team, it is important to analyse the situation, understand what your team needs at that moment, and use Servant Leadership [2] to empathize and see their point of view, ensuring everyone feels understood and can express how they feel. During my M1.1 project, I noticed my teammates felt unmotivated. With what I learned from the course, I planned a group reflection, facilitating an understanding and constructive discussion about what should be changed for the better.

Finally, a good leader should always focus on their growth and development to provide the best version of themselves to their team, which is achievable through personal leadership.

It is crucial for a leader to have a clear personal mission and vision before expecting others to trust and follow them. From my experience with the Usono case, I learned the importance of reflecting on who you are (Figure 2) and your personal mission and vision before discussing a common direction with a team. If a leader lacks personal direction, they cannot effectively lead others. This philosophy,

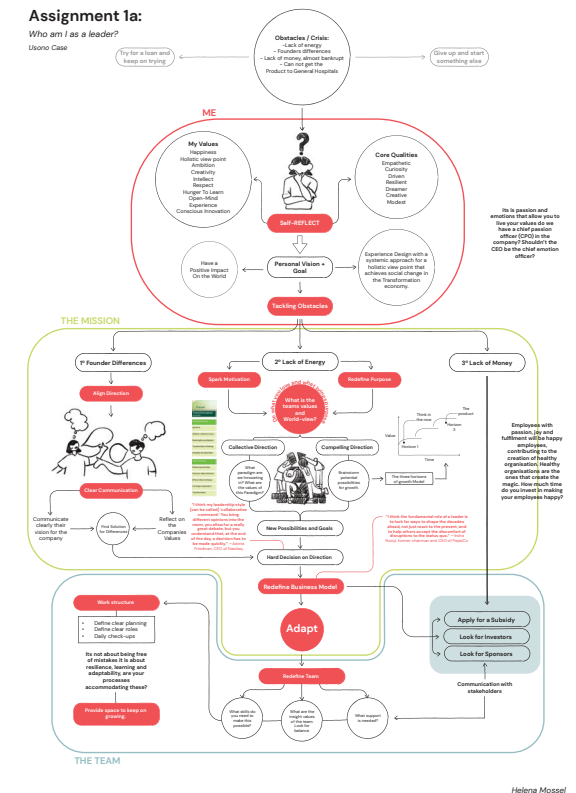


Figure 2: Assignment 1a

which I describe as personal value-based leadership, prioritizes aligning personal actions, decisions, and organizational strategies with core values. This alignment helps individuals also to understand their strengths and weaknesses, which is important for team balance and efficiency.

Being aware of strengths and weaknesses enables better decision-making in various contexts. Leadership is context-dependent, and a leader must address their team appropriately based on the situation. Context also influences values, as seen in the four economic paradigms [4,5]. Consequently, value-based leadership is essential for navigating innovation and adapting to new societal contexts.

I have learned that value-based leadership plays a key role in business and innovation. As society evolves and we transition to new economic paradigms, companies,

teams, and institutions need guidance. Value-based leadership aligns values with growth strategies, as learned through the Three Horizons framework (Figure 3) [6] used during the three client cases. It can lead to significant changes involving numerous stakeholders, as seen in the Catharina hospital and PostNL cases, and inspire internal change, as observed in the Jumbo case.

For me value-based leadership is not only about aligning directions and managing strategies but also about inspiring and helping people grow to their full potential by guiding them through their values.

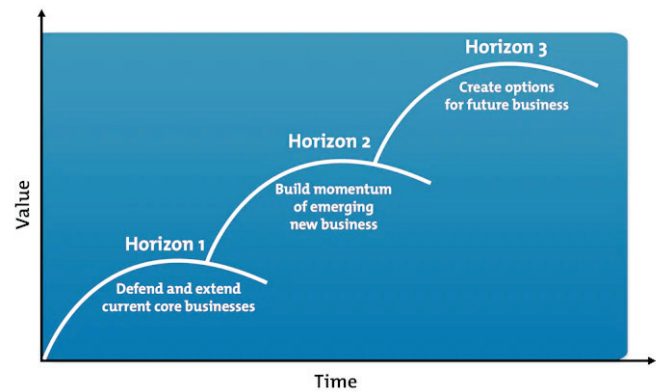


Figure 3: The Three Horizons of Growth [6]

Reflection on Personal Growth

When starting this course my learning goals were to learn how to lead a team and manage a project. But I quickly realized that this course was more than management techniques. It provided insights into how you could align your values to your actions and get the most out of your team that follows the same goal and how leadership can guide business innovation. Therefore, I adapted my learning goals to:

- aim to understand myself better and know how I can align my values with my professional identity and vision.
- aim to learn how to use value-based leadership in business innovation, through practice in the cases.

- aim to develop further my leadership skills to better lead a project.

This course has significantly influenced my learning development by helping me discover my values, further develop my skills, and build trust in group work.

From the first assignment, this course prompted me to reflect on my values as both a designer and a person. Working on various cases allowed me to experiment with different methods and personality tests, providing insights into my strengths and weaknesses. This process clarified my vision and professional identity, as I realized that as a designer, I am drawn to experience design, aiming to create holistic solutions for societal change in the Transformation economy (Figure 4) (4,5). My core qualities include empathy, curiosity, drive, resilience, creativity, honesty, and being a dreamer. I value a holistic viewpoint, curiosity and conscious innovation. This course helped me hone my personal leadership skills and learn how to take conscious steps towards my vision by aligning my values and core qualities to my actions and development decisions.

The course also enhanced my ability to empathize. Group work and reflections helped me understand my teammates’ perspectives and learn from their experiences. I also improved in communicating my concerns constructively. Indeed, communicating frustrations and concerns constructively is challenging, but my teammates taught me how to have productive discussions where I felt understood. This was achieved through reflection discussions at the end of cases or the beginning of meetings.

A crucial lesson was the importance of trust. Trust is vital in leadership as it motivates people to follow you, but it is difficult to cultivate. This semester, I aimed to trust more in the process and my teammates, being able to let go of the necessity to micro-manage my team. I learned that trust is earned by leading by example, showing reliability, and communicating well your expectations to your teammates.

Finally, I learned that leadership is not confined to a single person in a team. Through personal leadership, everyone can be a leader. Having multiple types of leaders creates a balanced team that can adapt to any context.

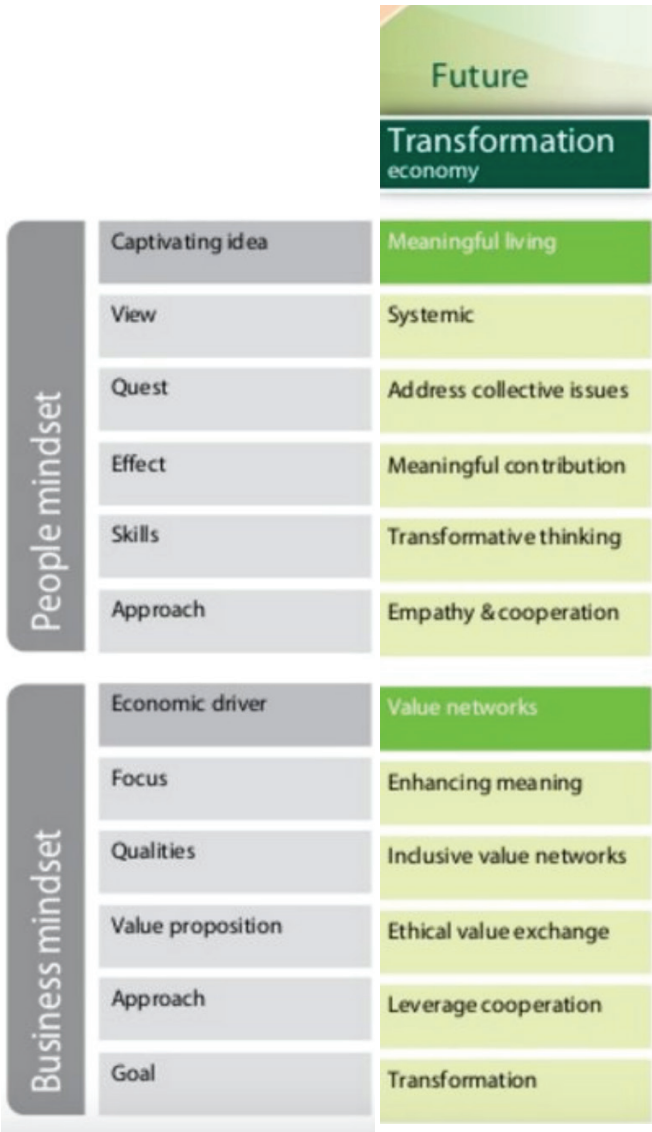


Figure 4: The Transformation economy paradigm [4]

Reflection on future development

Through this course, I have grown as a designer and personal leader. I now see the potential to apply value-based leadership to guide my design process, achieving results aligned with the values of the Transformation economy paradigm [4]. I aim to enhance my ability to reflect on the values that each solution should embody and align my process to create meaningful designs that adhere to these values.

In the present time, I would like to use my new insights on value-based leadership to mentor pre-master students, to help them formulate their vision and mission, just the same way I was able to make a clearer overview due to this course. Furthermore, I also hope to use my newly found knowledge in my freelance work, where I would like to transmit my values through my work. I also plan to use methods learned during the course, such as the Three Horizons framework and the Star Model, to better guide my process.

Additionally, I will continue to use value-based leadership throughout my lifelong learning journey, ensuring that I remain aligned with my values and qualities and continue growing toward my best capabilities.

References

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